have work to do.

What a Test match it has been.

We had arrived in Australia encouraged by the series win in England and thinking we could be competitive. As a squad, we were settled. As individuals, we were in form. We thought we could do well. We *thought* we would do well. I am not so sure we really *believed* we could or would do well ... at least not until the first morning of the first Test when the mighty Australians batted first and, after six blurred overs, were reeling at 15 for three.

It was exciting and exhilarating. The crowd was stunned into silence. We had landed the first punch.

They recovered of course and, at one stage, it looked as if the dangerous Andrew Symonds would take the Test away from us, but he was dismissed by Paul Harris and they were eventually 375 all out.

We stuttered in response. Graeme and Hash both batted well but each fell in the 40s and it was left to Jacques and me to take our score from a precarious 110 for three to a reasonably secure 234 for three. We were settled, planning to maintain our dominance and secure the first innings lead we felt would be necessary.

Then, in an instant, typhoon Mitchell Johnson ripped through our middle order. There are very few bowlers in the world who can literally turn a Test match on its head within the space of a few overs. Johnson is one of them. He took five wickets in quick succession ... boom, whack, boom, whack, boom. We collapsed from 234 for three to 241 for eight, looking every inch the latest South African side to subside with a whimper in Australia.

Typically, Mark Boucher dug in for a while, and hung around with the tail, scoring a priceless 26 as we staggered to 281 all out, still 94 runs behind. We were fighting hard. That's what we always did. And yet, somehow, we seemed to be always chasing the game, always a decisive step behind the home side.